Adrian Castellanos

Senior Software Engineer

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About

Senior software engineer with 8+ years of experience designing and operating distributed backend systems at scale. Specialized in **Go** and **Rust** services, Kubernetes platforms, and developer tooling. Led the migration of a payments platform to an event-driven architecture handling 40k requests per second at 99.99% availability. Looking for a staff-level role building reliable cloud infrastructure.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Nimbravo Systems — Los Angeles, CA ..... 03/2023 – Present

- Lead a 6-engineer team owning the multi-region control plane for a managed Kubernetes offering running 2,000+ production clusters.
- Designed a Raft-based configuration store in Go that cut cluster provisioning time from 11 to 3 minutes.
- Introduced OpenTelemetry tracing across 40 services, cutting MTTR by 35%.
- Mentored 4 engineers to promotion; ran the backend interview loop.

Go – Kubernetes – Raft – OpenTelemetry – Prometheus – AWS

Software Engineer | Lumenquay Pay — San Francisco, CA . 06/2018 – 02/2023

- Led the migration from a monolithic Rails checkout to Go microservices over Kafka and gRPC, letting 12 teams release daily instead of every two weeks.
- Built an idempotent ledger service processing $2B+ in annual volume with exactly-once semantics.
- Reduced p99 checkout latency from 850 ms to 210 ms through request hedging and a regional read cache.
- Shipped the checkout SDK in TypeScript, adopted by 1,200+ merchants within a year.

Go – Kafka – PostgreSQL – Redis – Terraform – TypeScript

Software Engineering Intern | Orbitrove Labs — Remote .. 06/2017 – 09/2017

- Implemented a Python CLI for reproducible ML experiment tracking, later open-sourced by the company.

Python

Education

University of California, Los Angeles | Los Angeles, CA .... 09/2012 – 06/2018

M.S. in Computer Science | GPA 3.9/4.0
09/2016 – 06/2018
Thesis: *Adaptive Consistency Levels for Geo-Replicated Databases*.

Distributed databases – Go – Jepsen – TLA+ – CRDTs

B.S. in Computer Engineering | Summa cum laude
09/2012 – 06/2016
Teaching Assistant for Operating Systems (CS 111) for 2 semesters.

C, C++ – Linux – x86 assembly – Verilog – xv6

Open-Source Projects

quill-kv | Embedded storage engine ..... 2022 – Present
Crash-safe key-value store built on an LSM tree with lock-free memtables. 2.3k stars on GitHub, used in production by 3 companies.

Rust – LSM tree – Tokio – Proptest

kubectl-pulse | Kubernetes CLI tool 2021
A `kubectl` plugin streaming live namespace health to the terminal. Accepted into the Krew plugin index with 15k+ installs.

Go – client-go – Cobra – Bubble Tea

Go contributor ..... 2020 – 2022
Six merged patches to `net/http` and `database/sql`, including a connection-pool starvation fix.

Technical Skills

Languages: Go, Rust, Python, TypeScript, C, C++, SQL, Bash
Infrastructure & Tools: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis, gRPC, Prometheus, Argo CD, Helm, Linux
Practices: Distributed systems, system design, observability, CI/CD, code review

Certifications

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | CNCF 2024

AWS Solutions Architect – Professional | AWS 2022

Terraform Associate | HashiCorp 2021

Talks & Languages

Zero-Downtime Control Plane Upgrades at Scale | KubeCon NA 11/2025

Exactly-Once Payments with Kafka Transactions | GopherCon 07/2022

English | Native

Spanish | Professional working proficiency (C1)